

The History Department

YEAR 8 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Early Modern World & Global Encounters (1450–1750)

Year 8 | How 'global' was Britain's transformation between 1450 and 1750?

SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

SOVEREIGNTY & POWER

Divine Right Absolutism → Civil War, Regicide & 1689 Settlement (L4–L6)

EXPLORATION & TRADE

Ottoman fall → Tordesillas → East India Co & Mughal trade (L1–L3)

RELIGIOUS VOLATILITY

Reformation zeal → Gunpowder Plot & Jacobean Puritan state (L2, L4, L5)

ENSLAVED RESISTANCE

Triangular Trade → The Brookes → Jamaican Maroons & Nanny (L7, L8)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Who held true global power in 1450, and why was Europe trapped on the edge of the world?  CHANGE & CONTINUITY	• Describe the economic, military, and territorial dominance of the Ming, Ottoman, and West African empires in 1450 • Explain how the Fall of Constantinople in 1453 disrupted Eurasian trade routes and isolated Europe • Evaluate whether Europe was an impoverished global periphery compared to the wealth of Asia and Africa	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Silk Road & Trade Bottleneck (1450); Source B: The Catalan Atlas Depiction of Mansa Musa of Mali (1375)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the wealth of West African empires using the Catalan Atlas and primary accounts of Mansa Musa.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 How useful are Sources A and B for investigating why European rulers risked everything to cross the oceans (1494–1588)? SOURCE UTILITY & PROVENANCE	- Explain how Martin Luther's Protestant Reformation of 1517 shattered Catholic religious unity across Europe - Describe how Spain and Portugal used the Treaty of Tordesillas (1494) to claim a global monopoly on trade and souls - Evaluate how religious hatred between Catholic Spain and Protestant England culminated in state piracy and the Spanish Armada of 1588	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Map of the Treaty of Tordesillas Meridian Line (1494); Source B: The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (1588) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the symbolism of the Armada Portrait and the defeat of the Spanish Armada in 1588. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]
Lesson 3 Trade or takeover: How did humble English trading posts turn into a corporate empire? CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE	- Explain how the joint-stock company model revolutionized English commercial expansion in America and Asia - Contrast the precarious survival of the Jamestown Virginia settlement (1607) with the East India Company's mission to Mughal India (1615) - Evaluate whether the British Empire originated from calculated territorial conquest or speculative merchant trade	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Contemporary Plan of the Jamestown Triangular Fort (1607); Source B: Sir Thomas Roe at the Imperial Court of Mughal Emperor Jahangir (1615) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Contrast the American experience with Sir Thomas Roe's embassy to Mughal Emperor Jahangir. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]
Lesson 4 Why was religious division such an explosive threat under King James I? HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE	- Explain the religious tensions in England following the 1603 accession of King James I and the enforcement of recusancy fines - Detail the conspiracy of Robert Catesby and Guy Fawkes to blow up the Houses of Parliament on 5 November 1605 - Evaluate how the state exploited the Gunpowder Plot through anti-Catholic legislation and the Oath of Allegiance	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Contemporary Engraving of the Gunpowder Plot Conspirators (1605); Source B: The Anonymous Monteaagle Warning Letter (October 1605) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the political consequences of the Plot for British religious identity and state power. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]
Lesson 5 How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 that the Civil War was an unavoidable fight against royal tyranny? HISTORIOGRAPHICAL DEBATE	- Explain how King Charles I's belief in the Divine Right of Kings and eleven years of Personal Rule (1629–1640) alienated Parliament - Analyze the outbreak of the English Civil War (1642) and the trial and public execution of King Charles I in January 1649 - Evaluate how the Commonwealth, Oliver Cromwell's Protectorate, and the 1689 Bill of Rights established constitutional monarchy	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Contemporary Engraving of the Execution of King Charles I (1649); Source B: The Great Seal of the Commonwealth of England (1651) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the transition from Cromwell's Commonwealth to the 1689 Bill of Rights. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]
Lesson 6 How did a Dutch invasion and the Bank of England turn Britain into a global superpower? TURNING POINT ANALYSIS	- Explain how the Navigation Acts (1651) and merchant capitalism stimulated Britain's oceanic trade and maritime power - Analyze the Financial Revolution, including the founding of the Bank of England (1694) and London coffee-house trading exchanges - Evaluate how wealth shifted from traditional feudal land ownership to commercial capital, creating a powerful merchant oligarchy	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Courtyard of the Second Royal Exchange, London (c. 1670); Source B: Claude de Jongh's View of London Bridge on the Thames (1632) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the rise of the "fiscal-military state" and the changing balance of British social power. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 7 What was the true human cost and commercial scale of the Transatlantic Slave Trade? HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & COMMODIFICATION	- Describe the three legs of the Triangular Trade connecting British manufacturing, West African captive markets, and American plantations - Analyze the horrific conditions of the Middle Passage through the forensic geometry of the slave ship <i>Brookes</i> (1788) - Evaluate the economic significance of slave-grown sugar and tobacco to the growth of British port cities like Bristol and Liverpool	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Schematic Map of the Transatlantic Triangular Trade Network; Source B: Diagram of the Slave Ship <i>Brookes</i> (1788) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate Eric Williams' thesis regarding the link between slavery profits and British industrialization. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]
Lesson 8 How did enslaved Africans fight back and dismantle the plantation system from within? AGENCY & RESISTANCE	- Describe the diverse spectrum of resistance used by enslaved Africans, from everyday sabotage to armed rebellion - Analyze the guerrilla tactics of the Jamaican Maroons led by Queen Nanny in the Blue Mountains - Evaluate the significance of Black agency and abolitionist activism, examining Olaudah Equiano's bestselling narrative	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Contemporary Print of the Jamaican Maroons in the Blue Mountains (1739); Source B: Frontispiece Portrait of Olaudah Equiano from his 1789 Autobiography DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the impact of Olaudah Equiano and Black abolitionists in dismantling the trade. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]
Lesson 9 How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment) SYNOPTIC ASSESSMENT & SYNTHESIS	- Synthesize Britain's 300-year transformation from a peripheral medieval island in 1450 to a global commercial empire in 1750 - Analyze the stark contrast between imperial luxury and domestic urban destitution during London's "Gin Craze" - Evaluate whether eighteenth-century Britain was an enlightened modern society or an exploitative imperial power	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: <i>The East Offering its Riches to Britannia</i> (1778) by Spiridione Roma; Source B: <i>Gin Lane</i> (1751) by William Hogarth DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the disciplinary concept of "modernity" in historical debate. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task]

KS3: Industrialisation, Empire, and Power (1750–1900)

Year 8 | Industrialisation, Empire, and Power: How did 19th-century Britain transform at home and abroad?

SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

SOVEREIGNTY & POWER

State institutions, governance, authority and constitutional development

TRADE & TECHNOLOGY

Economic engines, technical innovations and overseas geopolitical interactions

IDEOLOGY & CAUSATION

Religious beliefs, philosophical movements and drivers of historical change

RESISTANCE & AGENCY

Popular protest, social struggle, rights development and civilian agency

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?  TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION & ECONOMIC TRANSFORMATION	- Explain how coal and Watt's steam engine replaced the domestic system and water power. - Analyse how Henry Cort's puddling and rolling processes at Funtley transformed brittle pig iron into tough naval wrought iron, evaluating surviving physical archaeology along the River Meon. - Evaluate the relative importance of Portsmouth Dockyard's location versus technological genius in Cort's success.  Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period) L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m: Hook & Prior Retrieval • 10–30m: Modelled Shared Reading • 30–45m: Archival & Fieldwork Analysis • 45–50m: Formative Hinge Plenary L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m: Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • 10–25m: Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • 25–45m: Workbook Application (Pages 4–5) • 45–50m: Live Exemplar Debrief	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Coalbrookdale by Night (1801); Source B: Cort's Reverberatory Puddling Furnace (1783); Source C: Admiralty Navy Board Portsmouth Dockyard Trial Minutes (1787)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse how Henry Cort's twin inventions at Funtley (puddling and rolling) solved the Royal Navy's pig iron crisis, and evaluate the surviving physical archaeology at the site.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "How significant was Henry Cort's puddling process to British industrial and naval supremacy?"
Lesson 2 Was industrial work progress or punishment?  CHANGE & CONTINUITY IN AGRARIAN SOCIETY	- Explain how steam-powered factories replaced domestic handcraft with machine discipline and child exploitation. - Analyse how the Fareham Red Brick Boom connected local Hampshire clay pits to national imperial architecture like the Royal Albert Hall. - Evaluate whether the Industrial Revolution was primarily human punishment or societal progress using the Optimist vs. Pessimist debate.  Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period) L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m: Hook & Prior Retrieval • 10–30m: Modelled Shared Reading • 30–45m: Archival & Local Analysis • 45–50m: Formative Hinge Plenary L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m: Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • 10–25m: Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • 25–45m: Workbook Application (Pages 6–7) • 45–50m: Live Exemplar Debrief	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Powerloom Weaving in 1835; Source B: The Royal Albert Hall, London (1871); Source C: Parliamentary Sadler Committee Report (1832)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the Optimist vs. Pessimist historical debate regarding whether industrial work represented societal progress or human punishment.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was industrial work in 19th-century Britain an engine of human punishment rather than societal progress for the working classes?"

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 3 Did industrialisation make British towns unlivable? SOURCE UTILITY & WORKING-CLASS CONDITIONS	- Explain how rapid urbanisation, back-to-back housing, and cesspools created lethal conditions in industrial cities. - Analyse how King Cholera and the 1858 Great Stink shattered laissez-faire ideology, leading to Bazalgette's sewer network. - Evaluate the historical debate between Optimists and Pessimists regarding the living standards of the Victorian working class. Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period) L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m: Hook & Prior Retrieval • 10–30m: Modelled Shared Reading • 30–45m: Archival & Forensic Investigation • 45–50m: Formative Hinge Plenary L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m: Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • 10–25m: Shared Reading & Engineering Analysis • 25–45m: Workbook Application (Pages 8–9) • 45–50m: Live Exemplar Debrief	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Gustave Doré, Over London by Rail (1872); Source B: John Leech, A Court for King Cholera (Punch, 1852); Source C: Edwin Chadwick, Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population (1842) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate Edwin Chadwick's 1842 Sanitary Report and the 1875 Public Health Act using forensic archival evidence. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent did industrialisation make 19th-century British towns unlivable death traps for the working classes?"
Lesson 4 How was the British Empire built and sustained? CAUSATION & IMPERIAL EXPANSION	- Explain how mercantilist trade networks and the East India Company extracted wealth and raw materials. - Analyse how Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and steam industrial technology sustained the Royal Navy's global supremacy. - Evaluate the impact of British imperial rule on colonized peoples, contrasting corporate profits with indigenous de-industrialisation. Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period) L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m: Hook & Prior Retrieval • 10–30m: Modelled Shared Reading • 30–45m: Archival & Technological Analysis • 45–50m: Formative Hinge Plenary L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m: Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • 10–25m: Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • 25–45m: Workbook Application (Pages 10–11) • 45–50m: Live Exemplar Debrief	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Walter Crane, Imperial Federation Map of the World (1886); Source B: HMS Warrior at Portsmouth Royal Dockyard (1860); Source C: Robert Clive, Letter to the Court of Directors of the East India Company (1765) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the human and economic cost of British imperial rule on indigenous populations using archival dispatches. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the growth of the British Empire driven primarily by commercial technological enterprise rather than military and economic coercion?"

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 5 How did the Empire strike back? The 1857 Indian Rebellion RESISTANCE & LABOR MOVEMENTS	- Explain the deep structural grievances (Doctrine of Lapse, taxation) and immediate spark (Enfield rifle) of the 1857 uprising. - Analyse the major turning points, including the capture of Delhi, the leadership of Rani Lakshmibai, and the brutality of reprisals. - Evaluate the historiographical debate between colonial British and modern Indian interpretations of the rebellion. Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period) L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m: Hook & Prior Retrieval • 10–30m: Modelled Shared Reading • 30–45m: Archival & Military Analysis • 45–50m: Formative Hinge Plenary L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m: Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • 10–25m: Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • 25–45m: Workbook Application (Pages 12–13) • 45–50m: Live Exemplar Debrief	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Map of British Annexations under the Doctrine of Lapse (1848–1856); Source B: Lithograph of Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi Leading Cavalry (1858); Source C: The Azamgarh Proclamation (25 August 1857) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse how the rebellion spread and evaluate the symbolic leadership of figures like Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi and Emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent should the 1857 Indian Rebellion be characterized as a reactionary military mutiny rather than a widespread war for national liberation?"
Lesson 6 How did ordinary people fight for a voice? HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE (FAREHAM & PORTSMOUTH)	- Explain the causes and violent aftermath of the 1819 Peterloo Massacre and the repressive Six Acts. - Analyse the Hampshire Swing Riots of 1830 and the legal trial of the 1834 Tolpuddle Martyrs. - Evaluate the methods and historical legacy of the Chartist movement between 1838 and 1848. Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period) L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m: Hook & Prior Retrieval • 10–30m: Modelled Shared Reading • 30–45m: Local & Archival Investigation • 45–50m: Formative Hinge Plenary L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m: Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • 10–25m: Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • 25–45m: Workbook Application (Pages 14–15) • 45–50m: Live Exemplar Debrief	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: George Cruikshank, The Massacre of Peterloo (1819); Source B: The Threat of Captain Swing (Hampshire, October 1830); Source C: George Loveless, Statement upon Sentencing at Dorchester Assizes (March 1834) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the strategic split within Chartism between Moral Force and Physical Force using primary source manifestos. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent did working-class popular protests between 1819 and 1848 achieve their goals of securing political and economic rights?"

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 7 How did the road to democracy expand? CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE	- Explain the corruption of the unreformed electoral system (Rotten Boroughs, pocket boroughs, open hustings). - Analyse the 1832 Great Reform Act as a tactical compromise between aristocrats and the middle class. - Evaluate how the 1872 Secret Ballot Act and the 1867/1884 Reform Acts laid the foundations for mass democracy. Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period) L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m: Hook & Prior Retrieval • 10–30m: Modelled Shared Reading • 30–45m: Archival & Strategic Analysis • 45–50m: Formative Hinge Plenary L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m: Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • 10–25m: Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • 25–45m: Workbook Application (Pages 16–17) • 45–50m: Live Exemplar Debrief	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Parliamentary Representation Map of England & Wales & Unreformed Boroughs (1832); Source B: The Reform Tree (Satirical Engraving on the 1832 Reform Act); Source C: Minutes of Evidence taken before the Select Committee on Corrupt Practices (1869) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the transformative impact of the 1872 Secret Ballot Act and franchise expansions (1867 & 1884) on working-class political power. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the expansion of British democracy between 1832 and 1884 granted as a tactical concession by ruling elites rather than won by popular wor..."
Lesson 8 Who truly benefited from 19th-century transformation? CHANGE & CONTINUITY	- Analyse the "Optimist" argument using quantitative data on wages, public health, and technological innovation. - Analyse the "Pessimist" argument regarding working-class slum squalor, alienation, and colonial economic extraction. - Synthesize competing historiographical interpretations into a rigorous, balanced capstone enquiry essay. Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period) L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m: Hook & Prior Retrieval • 10–30m: Modelled Shared Reading • 30–45m: Statistical & Imperial Analysis • 45–50m: Formative Hinge Plenary L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m: Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • 10–25m: Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • 25–45m: Workbook Application (Pages 18–19) • 45–50m: Live Exemplar Debrief	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Historical Data on Real Wages & Consumption in Britain (1815–1880); Source B: Friedrich Engels, The Condition of the Working Class in England (1845); Source C: Dadabhai Naoroji, Poverty and Un-British Rule in India (1901) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the "Optimist" interpretation that industrialisation created unprecedented civilizational wealth and higher living standards. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Capstone Enquiry Essay: "Who truly benefited from nineteenth-century industrial and imperial transformation: the British ruling elite, the British working class, or the sub..."
Unit Key Vocabulary: Industrial Revolution • Industrialisation • Domestic System • Factory System • Puddling Process • Wrought Iron • Steam Power • Urbanisation • Slum • Back-to-Back Housing • Public Health • Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-faire • Child Labour • Factory Acts • Trade Union • Captain Swing • Swing Riots • Chartism • People's Charter • Universal Suffrage • Franchise • Rotten Borough • Pocket Borough • Great Reform Act (1832) • Secret Ballot Act (1872) • Empire • Colonialism • Imperialism • East India Company • Sepoy • Indian Rebellion (1857) • British Raj • Ironclad • Two-Power Standard • Historiography • Optimist View • Pessimist View • Synthesis		

KS3: History of Australia

Year 8 | Invasion, Settlement, or Survival? How should we remember the colonization of Australia?

SOVEREIGNTY & POWER

State institutions, governance, authority and constitutional development

TRADE & TECHNOLOGY

Economic engines, technical innovations and overseas geopolitical interactions

IDEOLOGY & CAUSATION

Religious beliefs, philosophical movements and drivers of historical change

RESISTANCE & AGENCY

Popular protest, social struggle, rights development and civilian agency

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Claiming Australia  HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	- Describe how and why the British Empire claimed Australia, including Captain Cook's voyage and the concept of terra nullius - Explain the significance of colonisation for both the British Empire and the Indigenous Australian peoples - Evaluate whether the British arrival should be understood as discovery, settlement, or invasion	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Secret Instructions to Captain Cook; Source B: A Portrait of Captain James Cook; Source C: Initial Encounter at Botany Bay  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Explain the dual purpose of James Cook's voyage, contrasting the public scientific mission with the secret government orders to claim territory.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 2 Creating a Convict Colony  HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	- Describe the key features of the convict transportation system and explain why Britain used Australia as a penal colony - Explain how the British Empire used convict labour to establish a colonial foothold in the Pacific - Evaluate the human cost of the convict system and its role in the revolution of Australian settlement	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Prison Hulks in Portsmouth Harbour  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse the work and social conditions of the convicts, contrasting general labor with the punishments of the chain road gangs.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 3 Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples  HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	- Describe the impact of British colonisation on Indigenous Australian communities, including the destruction of trade, culture, and land - Explain how Indigenous Australians showed resistance to British settlement through both armed conflict and cultural survival - Evaluate the significance of these encounters for understanding the long-term consequences of empire	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Bennelong's Letter to England; Early Settlement at Sydney Cove  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 4 From Penal Colony to Settlement  HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	- Describe how Australia transitioned from a penal colony to a free settlement through migration and the Gold Rush - Explain how empire, revolution, and change shaped the development of Australian society in the 19th century - Evaluate who benefited most from Australia's transformation and who was marginalised	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: William Barak's Testimony; The Australian Gold Rush  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?  HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	- Synthesise knowledge of colonisation, empire, resistance, and change across the history of Australia - Construct a sustained argument evaluating whose perspective should shape how we remember Australia's history - Deploy specific evidence to support a judgement about the legacy of empire in Australia	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the usefulness of primary sources for historical enquiries.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Write a narrative account analyzing the development of Australia between the years 1788 and 1855.

Unit Key Vocabulary: Ancestors • Botany Bay • Colony • Gweagal • Navigator • Royal Society • Terra Nullius • First Fleet • Convict • Governor • Hard labour • Hulk • Transportation • Sydney Cove • Eora • Frontier • Guerrilla Warfare • Dispossession • Massacre • Squatter • Merino • Gold Rush • Immigrant • Xenophobia • White Australia Policy